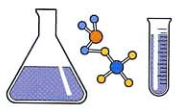
42 I can talk about my school

A School subjects


chemistry


physics


biology

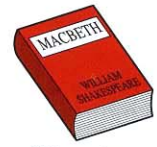


maths


ICT


geography


history

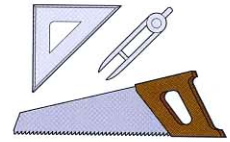


literature


music


art


PE


design and technology



modern languages

Chemistry, physics, biology, etc. are school **subjects**.

ICT = information communication technology
PE = physical education
RE = religious education

spotlight ***be good at something***

If you are **good at** something, you do it well.
If you are **terrible at** it, you do it very badly.
I'm (quite) good at languages.
I'm terrible at maths.

1 **Complete the words.**

▶ a rt
1 h_st_ry
2 g__gr_ph_
3 b__l_g_
4 d_s_gn
5 ph_s_cs
6 m_th_
7 m_s_c
8 l_t_r_t_r_

2 **Write the name of a school subject.**

▶ Beethoven, jazz, music
1 football, gym _____
2 computers _____.
3 Shakespeare _____
4 Spanish, German _____
5 church, mosque, etc. _____
6 CO_2, H_2O _____
7 Picasso, Monet _____

3 ABOUT YOU **Circle the correct verb form. Complete the sentences about yourself.**

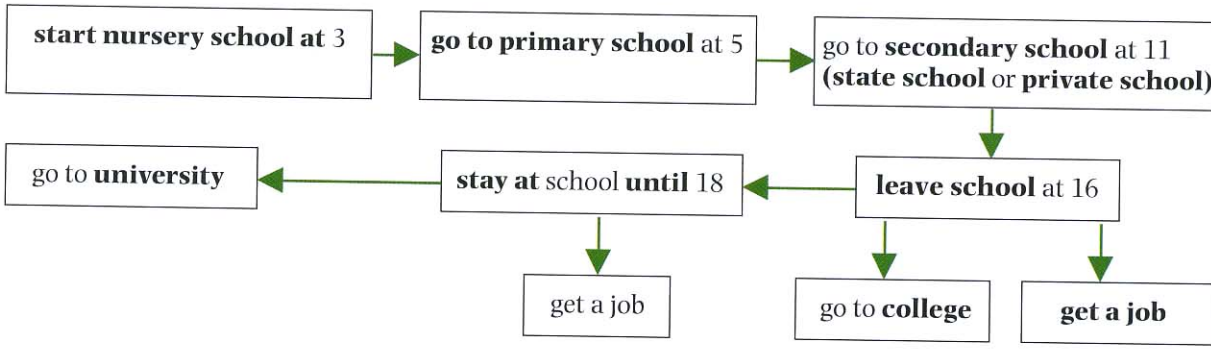
1 At school, I'm/I was good at _____.
2 I'm/I was quite good at _____.
3 I'm/I was terrible at _____.
4 We don't/didn't study _____.
5 The subject I like/liked most is/was _____.

4 **Test yourself. Cover the words and look at the pictures. Say the subjects.**

B The education system

Education in England and Wales

You can ...



Some **pupils** (= schoolchildren up to the age of 16) wear a **uniform**.

5 **Put the story in order.**

a where he learnt to read and write. ☐
b He stayed there until he was sixteen, ☐
c When Tom was three, [1]
d and then he went to college. ☐
e After that, he went to secondary school. ☐
f He left college when he was 18 ☐
g At the age of five, ☐
h he started nursery school. ☐
i he went to primary school, ☐
j and got a job in a bank. ☐

Glossary

start school go to a new school for the first time
state school a school where education is free OPP **private school**
stay at school go to school for a period of time (also **continue at school**)
until up to that time ('I was there until 3.00.' means 'after 3.00, I went away.')
college place where you can study after you leave school
leave school stop going to school
get a job find a job
uniform special clothes that children wear in a school

spotlight *at (the age of) ...*

Children go to school **at 5** (OR **at the age of 5**). = Children go to primary school when they are five (years old).

6 **Complete the questions, but don't write answers.**

▶ At what age do children go to nursery school?
1 When do they s..... primary school?
2 Do they usually wear a u..... at primary school?
3 When do p..... start s..... school?
4 When can they l..... school and g..... a job?
5 Do they go to st..... schools, pr..... schools, or both?

ABOUT YOUR COUNTRY

.....
.....
.....
.....
.....
.....

7 ABOUT YOUR COUNTRY **Write your answers to the questions in Exercise 6 or ask another student.**

C Exams

When I was at secondary school, I went to all the **lessons** and **did** my **homework**, but I didn't **work** very **hard.** So, when I **took exams** at 16, my **results** weren't fantastic. I **passed** six, which was good, but I **failed** maths. My **worst** result was physics – I got a **grade** E, which was terrible. After that, I went to a sixth form college where I worked hard and **did well**. I passed all my exams at 18 and went to university. That's where I am now.



Glossary

lesson a period of time (about an hour) in school when you are learning something
do homework U do work the teacher has given you to do at home (NOT ~~homeworks~~)
work hard work a lot
result what you get in an exam, e.g. 80%, A, or 8/10
(the) worst superlative of **bad** OPP **(the) best** superlative of **good**
grade you **get a grade** (e.g. A or B) or a **mark** (e.g. 15/20) in an exam
do well be good at something and get better at it OPP **do badly**

spotlight *exam (examination)*

An **exam** is an important test at the end of a period of study.
take an exam = sit down and write your answers in the exam
pass an exam = take an exam and do well, e.g. grade A or 85%
fail an exam = take an exam and do badly, e.g. grade D or 35%

8 **Look at Rafael's exam results on the right and answer the questions.**

▶ How many exams did he take? 7
1 Did he take an exam in chemistry? _____
2 How many did he pass? _____
3 How many did he fail? _____
4 What was his best grade? _____
5 What was his worst grade? _____
6 What did he get in English? _____

Exam	Grade
French	B
IT	C
Geography	D
Biology	A
English	C
History	B
Maths	E

A, B, C – pass
D, E – fail

9 **Complete the questions.**

▶ Six out of ten isn't a very good mark.
1 I have to _____ an English exam tomorrow.
2 Did you _____ your homework last night?
3 Paula did very _____ in her German exam; she got a _____ A.
4 I got my exam _____ yesterday. I passed all of them.
5 Andre is very unhappy at the moment. He's doing _____ at school, and last week he _____ an important maths exam.
6 Maths is my _____ subject. I'm terrible at it.

10 ABOUT YOU **Write answers to the questions or ask another student.**

1 How long are/were your lessons at school? _____
2 Do/Did you work hard at school most of the time? _____
3 At what age will/did you take important exams? _____
4 How many will/did you take? _____
5 Will/Did you pass all of them? _____